

“Inner source practices enable large organisations to break down information silos and promote internal collaboration”

In a conversation with *OSFY's Yashasvini Razdan*, **Laxminarayan Chandrashekar**, Principal Software Engineer, Siemens Technology and Services Private Limited, elaborates on how Siemens has been engaging with the open source community.

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Q What is the scale of Siemens' involvement in open source, and why?

A. In my experience, open source offers significant advantages to Siemens and other technology companies. With freely available source code, companies can avoid reinventing solutions from scratch, saving time and resources. Additionally, the absence of licensing fees and the community's proactive approach to identifying and resolving security vulnerabilities make open source an attractive option. Siemens also advocates fostering an open source culture within its organisation. Often, when any team within Siemens identifies improvements that could benefit the wider community, they have actively contributed those enhancements back to the original project through merge/pull requests. This not only reduces costs by eliminating licensing fees, but also allows developers to gain deep expertise

in the open source projects that they utilise. In fact, Siemens maintains and contributes to a whole list of open source projects which can be found at <https://opensource.siemens.com>.

Q So how do you draw the line between maintaining profitability and open source advocacy?

A. Balancing profitability and open source advocacy requires strategic decision-making. I believe in open

sourcing peripheral tools and utilities that align with product requirements and benefit the community, while keeping core intellectual property proprietary. By sharing such tried and tested utilities, the community benefits from the organisation's expertise. Moreover, open sourcing peripheral components allows for collaborative enhancement. If someone sees potential improvements, they can submit a pull request, which can be reviewed and integrated. This approach not only